

Chapter 35 Part 7

Liang Shi had egg pancakes and rice porridge for dinner.

It had been almost three hours since she finished eating, and Xu Qingzhu still hadn't returned home. To the messages she sent, Xu Qingzhu only replied with two words: "Busy."

The more Liang Shi spent time with Xu Qingzhu, the more she realized that some people's success wasn't without reason.

Just with this drive alone, she felt that Xu Qingzhu becoming CEO of a listed company was just a matter of time.

And what she could do was just prepare meals and wait for her to come home.

Because her luck points hadn't reached forty yet, Liang Shi had once sadly asked the system: "Why are luck points so hard to accumulate?"

And the system told her: "Host, you need to work harder! The host next door to me has already had a baby, and you're still here waiting for rabbits by the tree¹."

Liang Shi: "..."

"If I forced her to have a baby, your bad luck point system would kill me." Liang Shi retorted expressionlessly.

The system was sad: "I'm going to be emo. You need to be more proactive."

Liang Shi: "Then you need to tell me how to be proactive."

System: "...I'm just an AI, host."

Liang Shi was silent for a few seconds, then said gloomily: "I'm still a lifelong single²."

System: "..."

BGM suddenly started playing in her mind - "Why don't you just delete me? I can only say this through gritted teeth."

Liang Shi covered her ears: "Shut up."

The system couldn't help but give her advice: "I just went to flip through some romance novels. They're all pinning the female lead against corners saying - 'Is giving you my life enough?'"

Liang Shi held her forehead: "You should just shut up."

Liang Shi felt it would be better to delete this system.

But after finishing her conversation with the system, she looked at the time. She had been in this book for twenty days now, which rounded up was a month.

She still hadn't completed half of her luck point accumulation.

This road was truly long and arduous.

To be honest, the first half of her life had indeed been quite laid-back³, and this temperament hadn't changed much even here.

She only felt a bit of urgency when she first learned she only had three months, but afterward that urgency completely disappeared.

Mainly because no one gave her a clear target, and she spent half the time in the hospital.

It was just... confusion.

During the time Liang Shi spent waiting for Xu Qingzhu to return home that day, she made three plans, divided into Plan A, Plan B, and Plan C.

A: Continue being laid-back, slowly doing tasks.

B: Start sending flowers and gifts, picking up and dropping off from work, frequently creating contact with Xu Qingzhu.

C: Create bonds with Xu Qingzhu - have a baby.

She immediately ruled out both A and C, and B didn't really need consideration either.

She couldn't become a stumbling block on Xu Qingzhu's path to success. If someone suddenly appeared when she was desperately trying to act and prove herself, bringing flowers every day, inviting her to meals, and crazily taking up her time, she would want to hammer that person to death. Forget about liking them - it would be good if she didn't hate them.

As for Plan C, Liang Shi felt it was too despicable, not what a gentleman would do.

Plan A seemed most suitable for her, but... if she continued being so laid-back, she was afraid she might really lose her life someday.

Based on her speculation, the time when she could discuss divorce with Xu Qingzhu would definitely be after the original personality disappeared.

That meant waiting until her luck points accumulated to 80 or 100.

Previously, she had wanted to gain Xu Qingzhu's favor by investigating her parents' affairs. Since Xu Qingzhu was now so busy her feet barely touched the ground, all Liang Shi could do was approach from the side, trying to gain favorability without disturbing her work. But with the investigation interrupted, she was stuck in a bottleneck again.

Every day she thought about cooking for Xu Qingzhu, but that person was too busy to even come home.

Liang Shi was sitting on the sofa holding a book and thinking when Xu Qingzhu returned.

She had just walked over when she saw Liang Shi reading a book, but her book was upside down.

Xu Qingzhu: "..."

"What are you reading?" Xu Qingzhu asked.

This sound brought Liang Shi's wandering thoughts back, and she answered without thinking:
"Reading a book."

Xu Qingzhu looked meaningfully at the book in her hands, her eyes saying - Do you think I believe you?

Liang Shi looked down and discovered her book was indeed upside down.

...

She immediately flipped the book right-side up, but didn't continue reading. She just closed the book and stood up to ask: "Have you eaten?"

Xu Qingzhu asked: "Does eating a piece of bread count?"

"You only had a piece of bread for dinner?" Liang Shi frowned. "How can bread count as a meal..."

Before she could finish her denial, Xu Qingzhu said: "I only ate a piece of bread all day."

Liang Shi: "..."

Her steps toward the kitchen stopped, and she turned back to look at her. She found Xu Qingzhu extremely exhausted, already curled up where she had just been sitting, casually grabbing a cushion to put under her head. Her long hair was scattered at her sides, and two buttons of her white shirt were undone, revealing a large expanse of her collarbone area, which was soon completely covered by her falling hair.

Seeing this, Liang Shi's heart softened, feeling quite empathetic.

In the past, when she was too tired from filming and came back, she was in this same state. An emotionally draining scene might require twenty-some takes due to her co-actor's mistakes, and each time she needed the same explosive power. She would be completely drained.

After returning, she just wanted to curl up alone and didn't want anyone to talk to her.

But Liang Shi still couldn't help muttering quietly: "Do you really think you're made of iron?"

Xu Qingzhu heard this and laughed lightly, her voice also low: "Do you think I can't hear you?"

There were only the two of them at home, with no other sounds.

They could hear each other's voices clearly.

Liang Shi didn't argue: "I was saying it for you to hear. If you exhaust your body now, what will you do later? There's still time before the new product launch."

Xu Qingzhu rubbed her ears: "I know. You're like an old nanny."

Liang Shi: "..."

She poked her head out from the kitchen doorway: "Just consider me nosy."

But in less than two minutes, she brought out a bowl of steaming white porridge for Xu Qingzhu: "Get up and drink a bowl of porridge first to fill your stomach. I'll go heat up other things for you."

Xu Qingzhu reluctantly sat up and reached for the bowl with both hands, but burned her fingers.

Liang Shi immediately put the bowl aside and half-knelt in front of the sofa to blow on her fingers, frowning: "How can you be so reckless? It just came out of the microwave."

"I thought you wanted me to hold it." Xu Qingzhu spoke weakly but still argued with her: "Who knew it would be so hot?"

Liang Shi blew on her fingers, which were still red: "I'll get you some ointment."

"It's nothing serious, no need." Xu Qingzhu said: "It didn't even blister. I'm not that delicate."

Liang Shi looked again and still got up, but was pulled back by Xu Qingzhu from behind: "I said no need. I just want to eat."

"Alright." Liang Shi said: "I was just telling you to use the spoon in the bowl to scoop it directly."

Xu Qingzhu: "..."

She looked up: "Didn't you say you were going to heat up other things?"

"I can do that after you finish eating." Liang Shi said.

Xu Qingzhu: "..."

She silently picked up the spoon.

Xu Qingzhu ate quite quickly. She seemed truly hungry, eating spoonful after spoonful, and quickly finished the bowl.

Liang Shi asked her: "Do you want more?"

She shook her head.

"I'll make you a dish." Liang Shi said: "Five minutes, okay?"

Xu Qingzhu paused: "Liang Shi, I want to eat noodles."

"What kind of noodles?" Liang Shi asked.

Xu Qingzhu answered without thinking: "Boiled noodles."

1. **"Waiting for rabbits by the tree" (守株待兔)**: A Chinese idiom about a farmer who saw a rabbit accidentally run into a tree and die, then spent his time waiting by the tree for more rabbits instead of working. It refers to waiting passively for good fortune instead of taking action.
2. **"Lifelong single" (母胎SOLO)**: Internet slang meaning someone who has been single since birth and has never been in a romantic relationship.
3. **"Laid-back" (佛系)**: Modern Chinese slang meaning to have a detached, easygoing attitude toward life, derived from Buddhist philosophy of non-attachment.